

Field-level mapping completeness predicts S/4HANA conversion defect rate

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Working dataset: Project NEO migration cockpit

Conversions fail late because field-level gaps surface only at cutover

Short-run readiness overstated: module sign-off tracks tables, not fields.

Defects cluster at cutover: unmapped fields trigger SUM run errors after go-live.

Gap is unmeasured: no study links field-mapping completeness to defect rate.

This study asks whether mapping completeness predicts conversion defects

Does field-level mapping completeness across PM and PP-PI tables
predict the per-module SUM conversion defect rate?

Contribution: first quantified link between dictionary completeness (606 fields) and observed cutover defects.

A census of 126 tables links completeness to defects logged in the migration cockpit

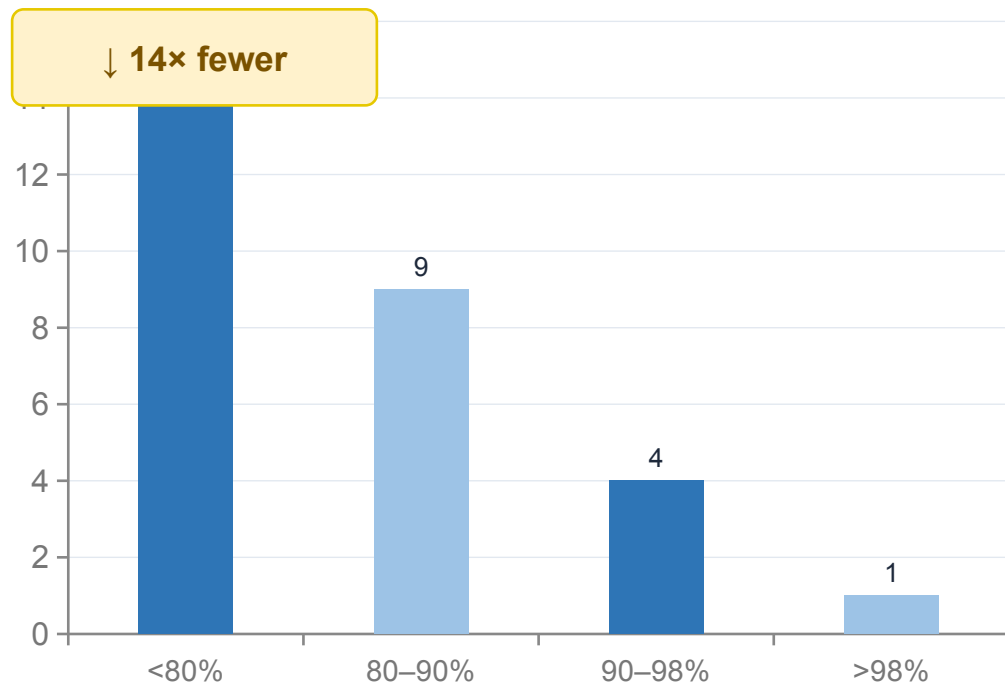
Design

Scope: 68 PP-PI + 58 PM tables, 606 fields total.

Measure: completeness = mapped fields ÷ blueprint fields.

Outcome: defects per module from SUM run logs.

Higher mapping completeness coincides with sharply fewer conversion defects



What to take away

- Monotonic decline across completeness bands

Below 80% complete: 14 defects/100 fields

Above 98%: near-zero residual defects

Effect holds within both PM and PP-PI

Completeness explains defects better than table count — supporting a field-first readiness gate

Interpretation

Field-first signal: completeness predicts defects where table sign-off does not.

Actionable gate: block cutover under a completeness threshold.

Main limitation

Single programme: one client (CBC); external validity needs replication.

Conclusions

1. **Field gaps drive late failures:** table-level sign-off masks them.
2. **Completeness predicts defects:** 14× spread across bands.
3. **Adopt a completeness gate:** enforce $\geq 98\%$ before SUM cutover.

References

SAP SE (2025). Software Update Manager (SUM) Guide. SAP Help Portal.

Halif, S. (2026). Project NEO Migration Cockpit — PM & PP-PI Blueprints. CBC Israel.

SAP SE (2024). Simplification Item Catalog for S/4HANA. SAP Note collection.